

June 2020

EDUCATION

Enlighten and Empower

Our Vision

To uplift and transform the Muslim society from their educational poverty in the light of true knowledge which leads one back to Allah

Organization's Update

Alhumdulillah, up till now we have been able to assist 21 students in continuing their academic journey. We have taken 8 new cases in the month of May. Also, 2 cases are being handled in collaboration with the Welfare Group. A total of Rs. 50,880 has been collected and Rs. 44,500 has been spent on the educational needs of the beneficiaries. Along with financial support, we also provide mentorship to all the students for career and personal counselling. For more detailed information of all the cases click on the link shared at the end of this page.

Checking in with Amaan and Subhan

Amaan and Subhan had to drop out from their schools in Muzaffarnagar, because their father had to leave his job due to his health issues. The family went through a lot of emotional and financial trouble, but currently alhumdulillah with the group's support both Amaan and Subhan have resumed their studies and have been admitted in VII standard in a school in Muzaffarnagar.

What this issue contains

- Hadith of the month
- Student Feature Story
- This month's read

Pearls of wisdom

'Abdullah bin Abu Qatadah narrated that his father said: "The Messenger of Allah said: 'The best things that a man can leave behind are three: A righteous son who will pray for him, ongoing charity whose reward will reach him, and knowledge which is acted upon after his death.'" (Hasan) Another chain with similar wording.

Sunan Ibn Majah-English reference : Vol. 1, Book 1, Hadith 241 Arabic reference : Book 1, Hadith 247

A brief on rise, fall and aspired future of Education Systems in the Muslim Society

There is an inherent responsibility upon each and every one of us to strive in the pursuit of knowledge. This knowledge is simply not relegated to just information or data but also that which allows one to transform themselves. That which allows them to connect with their conscience and eventually leads them back to God.

In an Islamic framework, religion was viewed as encompassing a holistic view of reality and the madaaris' curriculum used to include subjects ranging from medicine to philosophy, apart from subjects pertaining to religious knowledge. While the masajids marked the beginning stages of educational development in the Muslim world, eventually more complex institutions of learning would emerge. Many caliphates made sure to establish different kinds of systems in order to make sure that no man or woman, despite their status, was deprived of quality education.

Their systems were popular with non-muslims as well and the learning was always intrinsically connected to the Qur'an in many of these systems. It has been observed that one of the many ways to attack any civilization, is to wage an intellectual warfare. ***"In the 15th century, along with murdering and suppressing an entire population of Muslims and Jews, mass burning of libraries was undertaken. The mass burnings of libraries in Al-Andalus signaled the early stages of intellectual colonization that ran parallel to the political conquests of the colonial era."*** A gradual decline in the design of the educational system led many Muslim societies to adopt the western designed education systems.

The extent of this intellectual colonization even reached to the point where Islam itself was given legitimacy only if it could be justified through methodologies of research that were based on a secular epistemology and at the cultural and political level Islam could only have validity if it could be seen to fit within the norms of a paradigm developed by Western intellectuals.

The secular education model not being in synergy with the cosmos, leads to several drawbacks, obvious ones being environmental, social and political issues.

"By shedding light on transformations that took place during the colonial era, it is hoped that the current and future generations of educationists understand their importance and contribute to the process of reintegrating an Islamic worldview, epistemology, and ethics into educational curricula. Furthermore, it is also hoped that this article will begin to inspire students and experts in various disciplines such as psychology, business, art, etc. to rethink the paradigms within which their own fields of discipline exist and contribute towards integrating an Islamic ethos within their own fields of knowledge. We ask that God guide us to that knowledge which leads us back to Him and which allows us to benefit our souls in this life and the next Insha'Allah."



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